

People and their Environments

Human activity and energy

	Essential content
What is the importance of the secondary, tertiary and quaternary sectors of the economy? What are the relative merits of using renewable (e.g. solar) versus non-renewable sources of energy (e.g. coal and nuclear power)?	- The classification of employment by sector: primary, secondary, tertiary and quaternary. - The relative importance of these economic sectors in different countries and variations between and within countries. - Informal employment: causes and characteristics. - Factors affecting the changing location of primary and quaternary activities (prosperity, new technology, accessibility, transport, government policy). - Factors affecting the changing location of secondary and tertiary activities (prosperity, new technology, labour, raw materials, new technology, government policy).
What are the relative merits of using renewable (e.g. solar) versus non-renewable sources of energy (e.g. coal and nuclear power)?	- The rising demand for energy and the environmental consequences. - The concept of 'finite' energy resources and energy efficiency. - The relative merits of using renewable (e.g. solar) versus non-renewable sources of energy (e.g. coal and nuclear power).

Role and their Environments Environments and rural environments				
	Essential content	Scale	Required case studies	Recommended fieldwork opportunities (F) and practical skills (P)
at a national level	• Biomes and their global distributions. • Ecosystems and their components: rocks; soils; climate; vegetation; fauna; key ecological processes and concepts (adaptation, succession, zonation, food webs, biodiversity). • The nature of the temperate grassland biome and its agricultural use.	Global, national and small (local)	1 Case study of an ecosystem exemplifying ecological processes.	Investigating a small-scale rural and/or coastal ecosystem (F). Annotated sketch of a soil profile from photographs, eg chernozem, podzol (P).
at a regional level	• Characteristics of rural environments: employment; population size and structure; land use (including quarrying, recreation and tourism); accessibility; conservation. • The farm as a system. Different types of farming: arable/pastoral; commercial/subsistence; intensive/extensive and ways of raising agricultural production (eg irrigation, glasshouses, genetic engineering, HYVs). • Causes and consequences of food shortages and attempts to tackle these problems.	National and regional	2 Case study of a national park or protected area: management and reasons for protection. 3 Case study of two ways of raising agricultural production.	Investigating how a farm works as a system (F).
at a global level	• LIC rural settlement changes: farming changes (eg move to cash cropping); rural-to-urban migration and its impact. • HIC rural settlement changes: new economic activities; rural depopulation; counter-urbanisation; service provision.	National, regional and small		Location of rural settlements based on map and photographic evidence (P).

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age of tion s.	- The nature of urbanisation (including suburbanisation and counter-urbanisation); the factors affecting the rate of urbanisation and the emergence of mega-cities. - The problems associated with rapid urbanisation including congestion, transport, employment, crime and environmental quality.	Global and small (local)		Mapping of the changing global distribution of mega-cities (P). Investigating change in environmental quality survey (F).
ts can y the rent eople nic	- Reasons for factors encouraging similar land uses to concentrate in particular parts of the urban area (eg locational needs, accessibility, land values). - Consequences of different land uses, eg the distribution of different socio-economic and ethnic groups, accessibility. - Implications of rapidly developing urban areas in LICs, eg shanty towns (squatter settlements, location, growth, problems and mitigating strategies including self-help).	Small (local)	1 Case study of one city to show the land use patterns and the distribution of social/ethnic groups. 2 Case studies of shanty-town management in a LIC city and the contrast with unmanaged shanty towns.	Investigating change in urban land use (F).
urban and e	- The nature of, and reasons for, the changes taking place at the edge of HIC cities (eg retail complexes, business parks and industrial estates). The 'greenfield' versus 'brownfield' debate. - Areas of social deprivation and poverty in HIC cities: symptoms and locations. The changing fortunes of inner-city areas. - The roles of decision makers (planners, politicians, property developers and industrialists) in urban regeneration and rebranding.	Small	3 Case study of one named urban area in an HIC to explain how and why changes are taking place.	Annotated sketches of urban change based on the analysis of photographs and maps (P).